

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Defending a decision



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- What are the reasons that people choose a certain career or job?
- When have you taken the plunge and done something that was risky or intimidating?
- What does the phrase "you only live once" mean to you?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings, reactions, and decision-making.
- I can show I understand someone's feelings or situation and express agreement.
- I can express possibility and necessity.





Let's Explore!

Sally explains **YOLO*** to Vanessa.

* "YOLO" is an abbreviation that people use in texts. It means *you only live once*.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Now that I've got some food in my stomach, I might be able to tackle this head-on again.
- Sally:** Great! I must keep an open mind and be sure to consider all the possibilities.
- Vanessa:** So, you have to explain to me why you think floristry is a good choice for you to study.
- Sally:** Okay. First of all, I really love flowers and plants. And, I'm good at taking care of them. I've got a green thumb! My mother also loved flowers and I grew up surrounded by them. Don't you think that's a good reason?
- Vanessa:** Yes, that's a good reason, but it can't be the only one. You have to come up with several more motives.
- Sally:** Sure. Working with plants and having them around me makes me feel happy and serene.
- Vanessa:** Yes, it must be wonderful to be surrounded by green life all day. And I know you really love the smell of flowers.
- Sally:** I do! Wouldn't it be great to be paid to be with plants and flowers all day?
- Vanessa:** Yeah, it really would be great.
- Sally:** So ... admit it. Isn't it a great idea?
- Vanessa:** Well, I admit ... it does sound like it could be a perfect job for you. But aren't you worried that changing your career now is not the right move?
- Sally:** YOLO, Vanessa, YOLO.
- Vanessa:** What does that mean?
- Sally:** You only live once!



Let's Practice!

Vanessa expresses her opinion about Sally's situation.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Decide if the sentences express strong possibility, uncertain possibility or necessity. Write SP (strong possibility), UP (uncertain possibility) or N (necessity) in the given space.

1. I might be able to tackle this head-on again.
2. I must keep an open mind and be sure to consider all the possibilities.
3. You have to explain to me why you think floristry is a good choice for you to study.
4. You have to come up with several more motives.
5. It does sound like it could be a perfect job for you.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa tries to understand Sally's opinions.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. Don't / ? / a / to / think / for / study / you / good / me / reason / that's / floristry

2. be / to / plants? / to / get / around / great / it / paid / be / Wouldn't

3. job / paid / by / great / plants / surrounded / Isn't / for / a / being / ? / getting

4. changing / not / aren't / you / ? / worried / move / that / the / is / your / career / right / But

5. it / it / . / for / be / Well / could / perfect / like / you / sound / does / a / , / job





Extension Activity

Play the devil's advocate.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a letter to a friend describing a big decision you want to make. You can invent a situation.
- In your letter, be sure to have at least three reasons (pros) for why you think this is a good thing for you to do.
- Exchange your letter with a partner.
- After you read your partner's letter, write a letter back to your partner. In your letter you will "play the devil's advocate".
- For each reason your partner gives to make the change, give reasons (cons) that they should not make this change.
- Give your response letter to your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about feelings, reactions and decision-making.

☐ ☐

I show I understand someone's feelings or situation and express agreement.

☐ ☐

I express possibility and necessity.

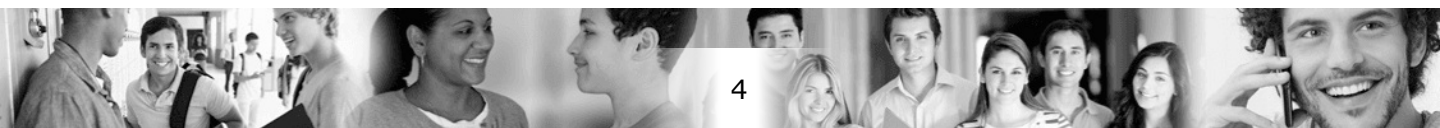
☐ ☐

I write a letter responding to a friend's list of pros with a list of cons.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- head-on** (adverb): to face a conflict in a direct way
e.g. Now that I've got some food in my stomach, I might be able to tackle this head-on again.
- to keep an open mind** (expression): to be willing to take into account different opinions or ideas
e.g. I must keep an open mind and be sure to consider all the possibilities.
- to have a green thumb** (expression): to be good at growing plants
e.g. I really love flowers and plants. And, I'm good at taking care of them. I've got a green thumb!
- to come up with** (verb): to be able to find or improvise something
e.g. You have to come up with several more motives if you want to decide to study floristry.
- motive** (noun): an incentive someone has for doing something
e.g. You have to find several more motives for making a decision.
- serene** (adjective): to be calm and peaceful
e.g. Working with plants and having them around me makes me feel happy and serene.
- the right move** (expression): the best direction or option someone has or can find
e.g. But aren't you worried that changing your career now is not the right move?





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Necessity

You use modals when you want to express possibility and necessity.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

**Might* suggests that something is less possible than *may* or *could*.

- *might* / *might not* + infinitive
- *could* / *could not* + infinitive
- *may* / *may not* + infinitive

Expressing Necessity

You use *must* or *have to* to express that something is necessarily true.

Example:

I must keep an open mind and be sure to consider all the possibilities.

Examples:

- *I might be able to tackle this head-on again.*
- *I must keep an open mind and be sure to consider all the possibilities.*
- *You have to explain to me why you think floristry is a good choice for you to study.*
- *You have to come up with several more motives.*
- *It could be a perfect job for you.*





Learning Points

Negative Questions To Encourage Agreement

Negative questions have a different meaning than regular questions.

A negative question can have two different meanings. For example, you may use a negative question to confirm that something you think is true, is actually true.

- *Didn't you see Ann yesterday? How is she doing?* (= I think, know, or believe that you saw Ann yesterday.)

A negative question is also used to express your opinions, or to encourage agreement. When you use a negative question, what you say sounds more polite.

- *Wouldn't it be fun to paint that walls purple?* (More polite than *'It would be fun to paint the walls purple.'*)

A negative question with a contraction has a different word order than one that is not contracted. When there is no contraction, the negative question is generally thought to be more formal.

Aren't you leaving? (Auxiliary verb with contraction + subject)

Doesn't he know? (Auxiliary verb with contraction + subject)

Are you not interested? (Auxiliary verb + subject + not)

Do you not understand what you have to do? (Auxiliary verb + subject + not)

Examples:

- *Don't you think that's a good reason?*
- *Wouldn't it be great to be paid to be with plants and flowers all day?*
- *Isn't it a great idea?*
- *But aren't you worried that changing your career now is not the right move?*

